

loose origin story

one night, when i am nine,
and my tongue is sore
from nudging
at the looseness of a tooth,
i ask my mother for a string.
the drunk drawer, she babbles,
with the other loose nails and assorted lids
longing for opens to close. and so i creak
the drawer ajar, presented with
a spool of string waiting
to be wound around
my finger crease. and so
it happens, and then i slice
the end with a kitchen knife because
i forgot about the scissors. in a blur
of motion, i tie a tiny slip
knot in the string. *a loop*
for a tooth, i think, but
as i am securing the knot to my tooth's
looseness, i lose grip. both hands grasp
air, the string is floating, sinking deep
within the abyss that is my throat.
and it's stuck,
snagged on something
i didn't know
was there. a gag
suppressed, i sit down
to wallow in the feeling.
it's been stuck there ever since.